

YA-WEN LEI

Harvard University
Department of Sociology
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EMPLOYMENT

Harvard University, Department of Sociology

Professor	July 2023 – present
Associate Professor	July 2020 – June 2023
Assistant Professor	July 2016 – June 2020
– Senior Scholar: The Academy Scholars Program, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs (2024–present)	
– Faculty Affiliate: Asia Center; Committee on Degrees in Social Studies; Committee on Regional Studies East Asia; Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies; Weatherhead Center for International Affairs	

Sciences Po, Centre d'études européennes and Centre de recherches internationales

Visiting Professor	September 2018 – June 2019
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Harvard University, Society of Fellows

Junior Fellow	July 2013 – June 2016
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District Court, Judicial Yuan, Taiwan

Judge; Specialization: Intellectual Property Rights	2000 – 2005
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Training Institute for Judges and Prosecutors, Ministry of Justice, Taiwan

Trainee	1998 – 2000
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Ministry of Examination, Examination Yuan, Taiwan

Officer	1997 – 1998
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EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATION

PhD, Sociology, University of Michigan	2007 – 2013
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– Committee: Greta Krippner (Chair), Mark Mizruchi, Peggy Somers, Yu Xie, and Mary Gallagher
– Dissertation: “Uncovering the Roots of the Nationwide Counterpublic Sphere in China”

** Winner of the 2014 American Sociological Association Best Dissertation Award*

JSD, Yale Law School	2006 – 2011
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– Dissertation: “Twin Challenges to Legitimacy: China’s Informal Handset Industry Economy in the Globalized Knowledge and Information Economy”

MA, Sociology, University of Michigan	2007 – 2009
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LLM, Yale Law School	2005 – 2006
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Passed the National Exam for Judges and Prosecutors, Taiwan (National Ranking: 8/3732) 1997
 Passed the National Bar Exam, Taiwan (National Ranking: 14/3915) 1997
 Passed the National Exam for Judicial Administration, Taiwan (National Ranking: 8/1991) 1997
 LLB, College of Law, National Taiwan University (Class Ranking: 1/62) 1993 – 1997

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political sociology; sociology of media and information technologies; sociology of work and labor; economic sociology; law and society; sociology of development; science and technology studies; Chinese studies

BOOKS

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2023. *The Gilded Cage: Technology, Development, and State Capitalism in China*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press.

- Chinese translation, published by National Taiwan University Press, 2025.
- 2025 Alice Amsden Award, Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)
- Bronze medal, 2024 Axiom Business Book Award, the International Business/Globalization category
- 2024 Max Weber Book Award, Organizations, Occupations, and Work (OOW) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2024 Asia/Transnational Book Award, Asia and Asian America (AAAS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2024 Best Book Award, Communication, Information Technologies, and Media (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2024 Robert K. Merton Book Award, Science, Knowledge, and Technology (SKAT) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2024 Choice Outstanding Academic Titles in Global Economics, American Library Association
- 2024 Walter Channing Cabot Fellowships, Harvard's Faculty of Arts and Sciences (recognizing its contribution to advancing scholarship in literature, history, and the arts)
- Covered by *The New York Times*, *The New York Review of Books*, *The Wire China*, and *China Leadership Monitor*
- Reviews: *American Journal of Sociology*; *Choice*; *China Information*; *Contemporary Sociology*; *East Asian Science, Technology and Society*; *Economic Sociology: Perspectives and Conversations*; *Foreign Affair*; *Global Media and China*; *H-Net Reviews*; *Journal of Cyber Policy*; *Journal of Urban Affairs*; *Political Science Quarterly*

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2018. *The Contentious Public Sphere: Law, Media, and Authoritarian Rule in China*. Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press.

- 2018 Distinguished Book Award, Sociology of Law Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2018 Gordon Hirabayashi Human Rights Book Award, Human Rights Section of the American Sociological Association
- Reviews: *American Journal of Sociology*; ASA Section on Human Rights Newsletter Fall 2018; *Choice*; *Contemporary Sociology*; *Foreign Affair*; *Governance*; *Pacific Affairs*; *The China Journal*; *The China Quarterly*; *Taiwanese Sociology*
- TV Interview: The Open Mind at PBS

Lei, Ya-Wen (2003). *Patent Litigation*. Judicial Yuan (In Chinese).

- The Third Prize, 2004 Judicial Yuan Legal Scholarship Competition

EDITED SPECIAL ISSUES

Hoang, Kimberly Kay, Jessica Cobb, and Ya-Wen Lei (2017). De-centering ‘Globalized’ Asia, *positions: asia critique*, Duke University Press.

ARTICLES AND BOOK CHAPTERS

Lei, Ya-Wen and Lin, Ching-Fu. 2026. “Surveillance in Asia: Co-Producing Law, Technology, and Political Regimes.” *Annual Review of Law and Social Science* 22.

Lei, Ya-Wen and Kim, Rachel. 2024. “Automation and Augmentation: AI, Robots, and Work.” *Annual Review of Sociology* 50:251-272.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2022. “Upgrading China through Automation: Manufacturers, Workers and the Techno-Developmental State.” *Work, Employment and Society* 36(6):1078–1096.

- Covered by *The Wire China* and the Blog of the Montreal AI Ethics Institute

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2021a. “Delivering Solidarity: Platform Architecture and Collective Contention in China’s Platform Economy.” *American Sociological Review* 86(2):279-309.

- 2022 Distinguished Contribution to Scholarship Article Award, Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2022 The W. Richard Scott Award for Distinguished Scholarship, Organizations, Occupations and Work (OOW) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2022 The Law and Society Association Article Prize, Honorable Mention
- 2021 Best Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- Covered by *The Stanford Social Innovation Review*, *Il Manifesto*, *The Rest of the World*, *Initium Media* (*duan chuanmei*), and *The Paper* (*pengpai xinwen*)

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2021b. “Publics, Scientists and the State: Mapping the Global Human Genome Editing Controversy.” *The China Quarterly* 246:400-27.

- 2021 The Gordon White Prize. The Gordon White Prize is awarded annually for the most original article published in *The China Quarterly*.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2020. “Revisiting China’s Social Volcano: Attitudes toward Inequality and Political Trust in China.” *Socius* 6:1-21. doi: 10.1177/2378023120915382.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2018. “Social Protest under Hard Authoritarianism.” *China Leadership Monitor*, 58(4), 1-10.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2018. “What Should We Know about Public Opinion in China?” Pp. 43-50 in *The China Questions: Critical Insights into a Rising Power*, edited by M. Szonyi and J. Rudolph. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press.

Hoang, K. K., Cobb, J., and Lei, Y. W. 2017. "Guest Editors' Introduction: Inter-Asian Capital Circulations, Cultural Transformations, and Methodological Positions." *positions: east asia cultures critique*, 25(4), 633-644.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2016. "Freeing the Press: How Field Environment Explains Critical News Reporting in China." *American Journal of Sociology*, 122(1), 1-48. Lead Article.

- 2017 Best Research Paper Award, Asia and Asian America (AAAS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2017 Best Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2012 Outstanding Student Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2012 Graduate Student Paper Award, Human Rights Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2012 Katherine Luke Graduate Student Paper Award, Department of Sociology, University of Michigan

Lei, Ya-Wen and Zhou, D. Xiaodan. 2016. "Embedding Law into Politics in China's Networked Public Sphere." Pp. 106-128 in *The Internet, Social Media, and a Changing China*, edited by Jacques deLisle, Avery Goldstein, and Guobin Yang, PA: University of Pennsylvania Press.

Lei, Ya-Wen and Zhou, D. Xiaodan. 2015. "Contesting Legality in Authoritarian Contexts: Food Safety, Rule of Law, and China's Networked Public Sphere." *Law and Society Review*, 49(3), 557-593. Lead Article.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2011. "The Political Consequences of the Rise of the Internet: Political Beliefs and Practices of Chinese Netizens." *Political Communication*, 28(3), 291-322.

- The First Prize in the Graduate Student Paper Competition of the 37th Research Conference on Communication, Information and Internet Policy

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2004. "Cyberlaw Special Report." *Technology Law Review*, 1, 1-45 (in Chinese).

REVIEW ESSAYS

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2024. Jürgen Habermas's A New Structural Transformation— The Decay of the Public Sphere and the Crisis of Liberal Democracy. *International Journal of Communication*, 18, 1-4.

Lei, Ya-Wen. 2018. Criminal Defense in China: The Politics of Lawyers at Work. *American Journal of Sociology*, 124(3), 961-962.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Lei, Ya-Wen. "Assembling a Geopolitical Developmental State: Semiconductor Onshoring in the United States."

Lei, Ya-Wen. "When Reproduction Becomes a Production Problem: The Gendered Labor Regime under Industrial Transplantation."

Lei, Ya-Wen. "Disjunctured Agency: Geopolitical Transplantation and the Limits of Embedded Agency."

Lei, Ya-Wen and Pengrui Ou. "Beyond the Dataist State: Platform Authority and Jurisdictional Struggles in Chinese Digital Governance."

SELECTED FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

External

- 2026 Berlin Prize fellowship (American Academy in Berlin)
- 2026 The French Institutes for Advanced Study (FIAS) Fellowship: Institut d'études avancées de Paris
- 2026 Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation Research Grant
- 2026 Radcliffe Fellowship (declined)
- 2025 Career Achievement Award, Communication, Information Technologies, and Media (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2025 Alice Amsden Award, Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE)
- 2024 Choice Outstanding Academic Title in Global Economics, American Library Association
- 2024 Max Weber Book Award, Organizations, Occupations, and Work (OOW) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2024 Asia/Transnational Book Award, Asia and Asian America (AAAS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2024 Best Book Award, Communication, Information Technologies, and Media (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2024 Robert K. Merton Book Award, Science, Knowledge, and Technology (SKAT) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2022 Distinguished Contribution to Scholarship Article Award, Collective Behavior and Social Movements (CBSM) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2022 The Law and Society Association Article Prize, Honorable Mention
- 2022 The W. Richard Scott Award for Distinguished Scholarship, Organizations, Occupations and Work (OOW) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2021 The Gordon White Prize. The Gordon White Prize is awarded annually for the most original article published in *The China Quarterly*.
- 2021 Best Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2021 Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation Research Grant
- 2018 D. Kim Foundation for the History of Science and Technology in East Asia Fellowship
- 2018 Distinguished Book Award, Sociology of Law Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2018 Gordon Hirabayashi Human Rights Book Award, Human Rights Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2018 Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation Research Grant
- 2017 Best Research Paper Award, Asia and Asian America (AAAS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2017 Best Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association, Honorable Mention
- 2014 American Sociological Association Best Dissertation Award
- 2012 Outstanding Student Paper Award, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2012 Graduate Student Paper Award, Human Rights Section of the American Sociological Association
- 2011 NSF Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant (Law and Social Science Program)
- 2011 Dissertation Fellowships, Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation for International Scholarly Exchange
- 2010 First Prize in the Graduate Student Paper Competition of the 37th Research Conference on Communication, Information and Internet Policy
- 2009-2011 Study Abroad Scholarship, Ministry of Education, Taiwan

Internal

Harvard University

- 2024 Walter Channing Cabot Fellowships, Harvard's Faculty of Arts and Sciences
- 2024 Weatherhead Center Faculty Research Grant
- 2024 The China Fund Research Grant
- 2023 The Dean's Competitive Fund for Promising Scholarship

- 2022 Weatherhead Center Faculty Research Grant
- 2021 George Kahrl Teaching Award in Sociology
- 2021 Nominee, Star Family Prize for Excellence in Advising, Harvard College
- 2021 Weatherhead Center Sabbatical Leave Grant
- 2021 The China Fund Research Grant
- 2020 Faculty of Arts and Sciences Clark Award
- 2019 Weatherhead Center Faculty Research Grant
- 2019 The Dean’s Competitive Fund for Promising Scholarship
- 2018 Weatherhead Center Faculty Research Grant
- 2017 Mindich Program in Engaged Scholarship
- 2016 Harvard Asia Center Research Grant
- 2016 The Dean’s Competitive Fund for Promising Scholarship
- 2016 Harvard Global Institute Grant
- 2014 William F. Milton Fund

University of Michigan

- 2012 Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship
- 2012 Rackham Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award
- 2012 Katherine Luke Graduate Student Paper Award, Department of Sociology, University of Michigan
- 2011 U-M Center for Chinese Studies Research Grant
- 2011 Barbour Scholarship for Asian Women
- 2010 U-M Center for Chinese Studies Research Grant
- 2008 Rackham International Student Fellowship

Yale Law School

- 2006 Lillian Goldman Scholarship
- 2005 Yale Tuition Fellowship

SELECTED INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

“The Great Chip Migration.”

- The Harvard Club of the Republic of China, June 2026.

“Assembling a Geopolitical Developmental State: Semiconductor Onshoring in the United States.”

- Academia Sinica (Taiwan), The Institute of Sociology, May 2026.

“When Reproduction Becomes a Production Problem: The Gendered Labor Regime under Industrial Transplantation”

- UCLA, Department of Sociology, the Seminar for Comparative Social Analysis, April 2026.

“Disjunctured Agency: Organizational Transplantation under Geopolitical Constraints”

- The University of Chicago, Department of Political Science, Comparative Politics Workshop, March 2026.

“Copy, But Not Exactly: Power Constraints, Dual Labor Regimes, and Organizational Dynamics in Semiconductor Transplantation”

- UCLA, Department of Sociology, April 2026 (scheduled).
- Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies, Harvard University, February 2025.

“Differential Inclusion and Fragmented Solidarity: How Migration Status and Experiences Shape Platform Work in France”

- School of International and Public Affairs, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, June 2024.

“Keynote Speech on AI and Governance”

- Global Urban Governance Conference, School of International and Public Affairs, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, June 2024.

“Telling China Stories on YouTube: Digital Labor, Transnational Publics, and the Platform Economy”

- École des hautes études en sciences sociales, Paris, June 2024.

“Developmental States, Semiconductor Firms, and Tech Labor in the New Phase of Globalization”

- The University of Michigan, China Reading Group, January 2024.

“The Gilded Cage: Technology, Development, and State Capitalism in China” (“Upgrading the Nation: The Promise and Peril of Techno-Development in China”)

- MIT, Department of Urban Studies and Planning, December 2025.
- New York University, Gallatin School of Individualized Study, November 2025.
- The Keynote Lecture in Political Economy, SOAS University of London, October 2025.
- The Patterson School of Diplomacy and International Commerce, the University of Kentucky, September 2025.
- The National Science and Technology Council, Taiwan, June 2025.
- Centre Internet et Société, CNRS, April 2025.
- Yale University, The Council on East Asian Studies, March 2025.
- Colby College, Department of Sociology, March 2025.
- University of Pennsylvania, Center for the Study of Contemporary China, October 2024.
- Cornell University, Department of History, September 2024.
- Koç University, Department of Sociology, May 2024.
- The Munk School of Global Affairs and Public Policy at the University of Toronto, April 2024.
- Simon Fraser University, Smythe Memorial Lecture, March 2024.
- The Asian Studies Development Program National Conference, Keynote Speaker, March 2024.
- Princeton University, Fung Global Fellows Program, February 2024.
- University of Michigan, Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies, January 2024.
- National Taiwan University, Department of Sociology, January 2024.
- King’s College London, November 2023.
- The University of Oxford, Oxford Internet Institute, November 2023.
- Microsoft New England Research and Development Center, November 2023.
- Rutgers University, Rutgers Center for Chinese Studies, November 2023.
- Berlin Contemporary China Network, November 2023.
- Stanford University, Management Science and Engineering, October 2023.
- Worcester Polytechnic Institute, April 2023.
- Harvard University, Dean’s Symposium (invited by the Social Science Division Dean), March 2023.
- Wellesley College, East Asian Studies, March 2023.
- Georgetown University, Department of Sociology, Departmental Colloquium, January 2023.
- Boston College, Department of Sociology, Departmental Colloquium, November 2022.
- Duke Law School, November 2022.
- Princeton University, Center on Contemporary China, November 2022.
- Columbia University, Department of Sociology, Departmental Colloquium, October 2022.
- Harvard University, Department of Sociology, Culture, History, and Society Workshop, October 2022.
- The University of Chicago, Department of Sociology, Departmental Colloquium, April 2022 (zoom).
- Brown University, Waston Institute, March 2022.
- Harvard Kennedy School of Government, The Program on Science, Technology and Society, March 2022 (zoom).
- Workshop co-hosted by the Centre for Asian and Transcultural Studies at Heidelberg University and the East Asian Studies (SEAS) at Freie Universität Berlin, December 2021 (zoom).
- Harvard Law School, East Asian Legal Studies, February 2021 (zoom).

“Techno-Capitalism: Social Challenges and Fissures in Today’s China”

- Harvard University, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, November 2023.
- “Rewiring the Chinese Techno-Nation”
- WZB Berlin Social Science Center, July 2022 (zoom).
- “Overwork and Class Origin among Coding Elites in China”
- Cornell University, ILR School, October 2022.
 - Peking University, Center for Social Research, October 2002 (zoom).
- “Delivering Solidarity: Platform Architecture and Collective Contention in China’s Platform Economy”
- Taiwanese Sociological Association, Keynote Speech, November 2021.
 - York University, The Korean Office for Research and Education, October 2021 (zoom).
 - Yale Law School and University of Toronto, East Asian Legal Studies Series, October 2021 (zoom).
 - University of Minnesota, Charles Babbage Institute, October 2020 (zoom).
 - Yale University, Department of Sociology, Comparative Research Workshop, December 2019.
 - University of Michigan, Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies, October 2019.
- “Revisiting China’s Social Volcano: Attitudes toward Inequality and Political Trust in China.”
- Harvard University, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, October 2019.
- “Publics, Scientists, and The State: Mapping The Global Human Genome Editing Controversy, 2015–2019”
- University of Michigan, Lieberthal-Rogel Center for Chinese Studies, October 2021 (zoom).
 - Stanford University, Department of Sociology Colloquium, October 2019.
 - Harvard University, Society of Fellows, July 2019.
- “From Factories to Food Delivery Platforms: Contingent Contractual Relationships in China’s Platform Economy”
- Columbia University, Department of Sociology Colloquium, April 2019.
- “Humans vs. Robots: (Re) Valuating The Worth of Work in The Age of Automation”
- University of British Columbia, Centre for Chinese Research, October 2018.
 - University of Pennsylvania, Center for the Study of Contemporary China, September 2018.
- “Class-Based Discontents in The Shadow of Development and Law”
- Sciences Po, Centre d’études européennes, November 2018.
 - National Taiwan University, Department of Sociology Colloquium, June 2018.
- “The Contentious Public Sphere in China: Law, Media and The Dilemma of Authoritarian Rule”
- New York University, Department of Media, Culture, and Communication, April 2020 (zoom).
 - Boston University, Department of Sociology, April 2020 (zoom).
 - École des hautes études en sciences, centre de recherches historiques, February 2019.
 - Simon Fraser University, Department of History workshop, October 2018.
 - Yale Law School, Paul Tsai China Center, April 2018.
 - Duke University, Center for International and Global Studies, April 2018.
 - Cornell University, East Asia Workshop, November 2017.
 - National Taiwan University, Department of Sociology Colloquium, July 2017.
 - Brandeis University, Department of Sociology Colloquium, November 2016.
 - Duke University, Department of Sociology, November 2016.
 - University of California at Berkeley, Department of sociology Colloquium, April 2015.
 - Brown University, Department of Sociology, November 2014.
- “Political Apathy in China, 1992-2012”
- Harvard Law School, East Asian Legal Studies, April 2017.

“Freeing The Press: How Field Environment Explains Critical News Reporting in China”

- Harvard University, Department of Economics workshop, February 2016.

“Contesting Legality in Authoritarian Contexts: Food Safety, Rule of Law and China’s Networked Public Sphere”

- Duke Law School Colloquium, November 2016.

“Embedding Law into Politics in China’s Networked Public Sphere”

- University of Pennsylvania, Center for the Study of Contemporary China, February 2014.

TEACHING

*** 2021 George Kahrl Teaching Award in Sociology**

*** 2017 Faculty Curricular Innovation Award, the Mindich Program for Engaged Scholarship at Harvard College**

Soc 1141 Contemporary Chinese Society (undergraduate and graduate levels)

- 2016 Fall; 2017 Fall; 2019 Fall; 2020 Fall; 2023 Spring; 2024 Spring; 2025 Spring; 2026 Spring
- Mindich Program in Engaged Scholarship

Soc 182 Law and Society (undergraduate level)

- 2017 Spring; 2018 Spring; 2023 Fall; 2024 Fall; 2025 Fall
- Mindich Program in Engaged Scholarship

Soc 98 Junior Tutorial: Media, Society, and Social Change (undergraduate level)

- 2017 Fall

Soc 2209 Qualitative Social Analysis (graduate level)

- 2020 Spring; 2021 Spring

Soc 3317 Soc Culture, History, and Society Workshop (graduate level; co-teach with Orlando Patterson)

- 2016 Fall; 2017 Spring; 2017 Fall; 2018 Spring; 2020 Fall; 2021 Spring; 2021 Fall; 2022 Spring; 2022 Fall; 2023 Spring; 2023 Fall; 2024 Spring; 2024 Fall; 2025 Spring; 2025 Fall

MENTORING AND ADVISING

Sociology Ph.D. Program at Harvard

- Yanhua Bird (qualification exam committee and Ph.D. dissertation committee)
Defended in May 2020; Assistant Professor, Boston University Questrom School of Business
- Clayton C. Covington (dissertation committee)
- Jenna Cook (qualification exam committee and Ph.D. dissertation committee)
in May 2025
- Jingyun Dai (qualification exam committee)
- Nayun Eom (academic advisor and chair of qualification exam committee)
- Daniel Alain Evrard (dissertation committee)
- Andrew Keefe (dissertation committee)
- Mark Griffith (qualification exam committee)
- Zhongke Han (academic advisor)
- Rachel Kim (advisor and chair of Ph.D. dissertation committee)
- Jeremy Mopsick (academic advisor)
- Madison Renner (qualification exam committee and co-chair of Ph.D. dissertation committee)

- Cierra Robson (first-year advisor, co-chair of qualification exam committee, co-chair of Ph.D. dissertation committee) Defended in April 2024; JD student at Yale Law School
- Emily Tedards (qualification exam committee)
- Amy Tsang (dissertation committee)
Defended in August 2023
- Zehra Yildirim (dissertation committee)
- Shira Zilberstein (academic advisor in the spring term of 2019-2020, qualification exam committee, dissertation committee)
Defended in April 2026
- Yueran Zhang (qualification exam committee)
Assistant Professor of Sociology, University of Chicago
- Yun Zhou (mentor)
Assistant Professor of Sociology, University of Michigan
- Fangsheng Zhu (qualification exam committee and Ph.D. dissertation committee)
Defended in April 2022; Assistant Professor of Sociology, Duke Kunshan University

Sociology PhD Programs at Other Universities

- Canhui Lui (PhD dissertation committee, Department of Sociology, Cambridge University)
- Swati Chintala (PhD dissertation committee, NYU, Department of Sociology)
Defended in April 2024
- Hui Huang (PhD dissertation committee, King's College London, Department of International Development)
Defended in January 2023; Assistant Professor, School of International and Public Affairs, Shanghai Jiao Tong University
- Qi Song (PhD dissertation committee, Northwestern, Department of Sociology)
Defended in July 2024 Defended in June 2024; postdoctoral researcher at the University of Toronto
- JS Tang (PhD general exam committee, MIT, Department of Urban Studies and Planning)
- Jack Linzhou Xing (PhD dissertation committee, Georgia Institute of Technology, School of History and Sociology)
Defended in June 2025; An Wang Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard University
- Rose Xueqing Zhang (external examiner of the PhD dissertation, University of British Columbia, Department of Sociology)
Defended in 2026
- Derek Zhao (PhD dissertation committee, University of Illinois at Chicago, Department of Sociology)
- Yingzhe Zheng (PhD dissertation committee, Northwestern, Department of Sociology)

The Doctor of Juridical Science (SJD) Program at Harvard Law School

- Xuejiao (Katniss) Li (mentor, Harvard Law School SJD program)
- Wei-An Tsai (field supervisor, Harvard Law School SJD program)
- Guanchi Zhang (mentor, Harvard Law School SJD program)
Assistant Professor of Law, Vermont Law and Graduate School
- Yiran Zhang (mentor, Harvard Law School SJD program)
Assistant Professor, Cornell University, ILR School

Committee on Regional Studies East Asia (RSEA) at Harvard

- Anthony Comeau (independent study advisor)
- Bridget Nicolas (**thesis advisor, 2019-2021**)
Honorable mention for the 2021 Joseph Fletcher Memorial Award
- Chuanmeng Shi (**academic advisor**)
- Jiyoung Sohn (mentor, 2018-2021)
- Jamie Tang (**academic and thesis advisor, 2024-2026**)
admitted to the Sociology PhD program at Northwestern University, 2026
- Junchao Tang (**academic and thesis advisor, 2018-2020**)
admitted to the Sociology PhD program at the University Michigan, 2026

- Si (Celine) Qin (**thesis advisor, 2021-2023**)
- Cindy Xin (**thesis advisor**)
- Kejian Yan (**academic advisor, 2024-2026**)
admitted to the Anthropology PhD program at Stanford University, 2026

Undergraduates at Harvard

- Fay Asimakopoulos (social studies, 2016-2017)
- Kathryn Bussey (social studies, 2016-2017)
Yale Law School JD student
- Xue Dong (sociology, 2017-2018)
- Louis Leblanc (sociology, 2017-2018)
- Tae Yeong Park (sociology, 2017-2018)
- James Rose (advisor, special concentration “law, finance, and political economy,” 2020-2022)
Admitted to the A.M. program in Regional Studies–East Asia
- Hank Sparks (government, 2016-2017)
JD student at Stanford Law School
- Alice Xiaolin Zhang (thesis advisor, social studies, 2020-2021)

Postdoctoral fellows or other researchers at Harvard

- Yasemin Bavbek (postdoctoral fellow, Social Studies Program, 2024-2025)
- Guanxin Fang (visiting fellow from Nanjing University, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2016-2017)
Associate Professor at the Party School of CPC Jiangsu Provincial Committee, China
- Weirong Guo (postdoctoral fellow, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, 2024-2025)
- Gozde Guran (Weatherhead Center Academy Scholars Program, 2024-2025)
- Sarah Halford (postdoctoral fellow, Department of Sociology, 2024-2025)
- Jamie Hinton (Weatherhead Center Academy Scholars Program, 2025-2026)
- Jaw-Nian Huang (postdoctoral fellow, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2016-2017)
Assistant Professor at the Graduate Institute of Development Studies of the National Chengchi University, Taiwan
- Poyao Huang (postdoctoral fellow, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2020-2021)
Researcher at the Research Institute for the Humanities and Social Sciences, Taiwan
- Dang Thi Viet Phuong (visiting scholar, Harvard Yenching Institute, 2024-2025)
- Sarah Plovnick (postdoctoral fellow, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2024-2025)
- Ruby YS LAI (visiting scholar, Harvard Yenching Institute, 2025-2026)
- Miao Li (visiting scholar, Harvard Yenching Institute, 2024-2025)
- Wan-Zi Lu (postdoctoral fellow, Weatherhead Center for International Affairs, 2025-2026)
- Maha Shehade Switat (postdoctoral fellow, Department of Sociology, 2024-2025)
- Fumiya Uchikoshi (Weatherhead Center Academy Scholars Program, 2025-2026)
- Jamie Wong (Weatherhead Center Academy Scholars Program, 2024-2025)
- Linzhou Jack Xing (An Wang Postdoctoral Fellow, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2025-2026)
- Yuxin Zhang (An Wang Postdoctoral Fellow, Fairbank Center for Chinese Studies, 2025-2026)
- Zekun Zhang (Weatherhead Center Academy Scholars Program, 2024-2025)

DEPARTMENTAL AND UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Departmental Service

- Admission Committee: 2016-2017; 2019-2020; 2022-2023; 2025-2026
- Colloquium Committee: 2016-2017; 2022-2023
- Committee on Higher Degrees: 2026-2026
- Committee on Inclusion and Professionalism: 2020-2021
- Committee on Undergraduate Degrees: 2017-2018
- Fall Dissertation Proposal Workshop: 2023-2024

- General Written Exam: 2019-2020; 2024-2025
- Tenure Review Committee: 2023-2024
- Junior Search Committee: 2024-2025
- Senior Search Committee (chair): 2024-2025

University Service

- Admission Committee, A.M. Degree in Regional Studies-East Asia (RSEA): 2019-2020
- An Wang Postdoctoral Fellowship Selection Committee, Fairbank Center: 2019-2020; 2023-2024; 2024-2025; 2025-2026
- Advisory Committee, Fairbank Center: 2023-2024; 2024-2025
- Council Committee, Asia Center: 2017-present
- Executive Committee, Weatherhead Center: 2024-2027
- Fellowship Selection Committee, Harvard Yenching: 2017-2018; 2019-2020; 2021-2022; 2024-2025
- Hoopes Prize Selection Committee: 2016-18; 2019-2021; 2022-2026
- Hou Family Fellowship Selection Committee, Fairbank Center: 2016-2017; 2024-2025; 2025-2026
- Mid-dissertation Grant Committee, Weatherhead Center: 2020-2021
- Panel Organizing Committee for Fairbank Center's Sixtieth Year Anniversary Symposium, Fairbank Center: 2016-2017
- Research Travel Grants for Graduate Students, Asia Center: 2019-2020
- Scholars Program Selection Committee, Weatherhead Center: 2023-2025
- Search Committee, Department of Anthropology: 2024-2025
- Second Year Review Committee (Jamie Martin), Department of History and Social Studies: 2023-2024
- Senior Advisers and Executive Committee, Weatherhead Center: 2024-2026
- Senior Lectureship Review Committee (Daniel Koss), East Asian Languages and Civilizations: 2022-2023
- Senior Scholar, Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies, Weatherhead Center: 2024-2026
- Standing Committee on the A.M. Degree, Regional Studies-East Asia (RSEA): 2019-2020; 2025-2026
- Standing Committee on the Degrees in Social Studies: 2023-2025
- Steering Committee, Harvard China Fund: 2018-2026
- Steering Committee, Weatherhead Center: 2024-2027
- Steering Committee, Harvard Yenching: 2019-2020; 2021-2022
- Trustee, Harvard Yenching: 2024-2028

Professional Service

- Ad hoc consultant for the U.S. House of Representatives Permanent Select Committee on Intelligence
- Chair of the Best Paper Award Committee, Communication, Information, Technologies, and Media Sociology Section (CITAMS) of the American Sociological Association, 2022
- Chair of the Distinguished Book Award Committee, Sociology of Law Section of the American Sociological Association, 2019
- Editorial Board of Johns Hopkins University Press's Studies in Computing and Culture series, 2021-2024
- Editorial Board of *Law and Social Inquiry*, 2019-2022
- Editorial Board of *American Sociological Review*, 2025-2028
- Member of the Advisory Committee, Center for Contemporary China Studies, National Tsing Hua University Taiwan, 2025-2028
- Member of the Academic Advisory Committee, Institute of Sociology, Academia Sinica, Taiwan, 2025-2028
- Member of the Alice Amsden Book Award Committee, Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics (SASE). 2025
- Member of the Best Book Award Committee, Communication, Information Technologies, and Media (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association, 2025
- Member of the Career Achievement Award Committee, Communication, Information Technologies, and Media (CITAMS) Section of the American Sociological Association, 2025

- Member of the Max Weber Book Award Committee, Organizations, Occupations, and Work (OOW) Section of the American Sociological Association, 2025
- Member of Robert K. Merton Book Award Committee, Science, Knowledge, and Technology (SKAT) Section of the American Sociological Association, 2025
- Member of the Graduate Student Paper Award Committee, Human Rights Section of the American Sociological Association, 2017
- Member of the National Screening Committee, US Fulbright Program, 2024-2025
- Member of the Tang Prize Selection Committee for Sinology, 2026
- Public Intellectual Program, National Committee on US-China Relations, 2019-2020
- Service to media (e.g., BBC, CNBC, CNN, The New York Times, etc)
- Academic review

Tenure and promotion to full professorship:

I have reviewed tenure, promotion to full professorship, and promotion to distinguished professorship cases for academic institutes and universities in Australia (The Australian National University), Canada (School of Communication, Simon Fraser University), China (Department of Sociology, Zhejiang University; Department of Sociology, Tsinghua University), the United States (Cornell University School of Industrial and Labor Relations; Department of Sociology, Brigham Young University; Department of Sociology, Emory University; Department of Sociology, Stanford University; Freeman Spogli Institute for International Studies, Stanford University; Patterson School of Diplomacy and International Commerce, University of Kentucky; Department of Sociology, Texas A&M University; Boston College Law School), Singapore (Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore), and Taiwan (Institute of Sociology, Academia Sinica; Department of Political Science, National Taiwan University).

Journal articles in sociology, political science, law and society, communication studies, Chinese studies, industrial relations, and science and technology studies:

American Journal of Sociology, American Political Science Review, American Sociological Review, Big Data & Society, Current Sociology, East Asian Science, Technology and Society, International Journal of Communication, International Journal of Law and Context, International Journal of Press/Politics, Industrial and Labor Relations Review, Journal of Chinese Political Science, Law and Society Review, Law and Social Inquiry, Political Behavior, Political Communication, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, The China Quarterly, Theory and Society, Socio-Economic Review, Sociology Compass, Sociology of Development, Sociological Forum, Sociological Perspectives, Socius, Studies in Comparative International Development, Qualitative Inquiry, Qualitative Sociology, and Work, Employment and Society

Book proposals and manuscripts:

Columbia University Press, Harvard University Press, Oxford University Press, Princeton University Press, University of California Press, and Routledge

Grant proposals:

Academia Sinica (Taiwan), Swiss National Science Foundation (Switzerland), and the University of Strasbourg Institute for Advanced Study (France)

Job applications in law, sociology, and political science:

The Institutum Iurisprudentiae, Academia Sinica (Taiwan), The Institute of Sociology, Academia Sinica (Taiwan), and the National Taiwan University (Department of Political Science)

LANGUAGES

- Mandarin Chinese (native)
- Taiwanese (native)

- English (proficient)
- French (limited working proficiency)